

e_{ml}★ — Minimal Anti-Holomorphic Extension of the EML Sheffer Operator

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Date: May 2026

Extension of: Odrzywołek (arXiv:2603.21852v2)

GitHub: https://github.com/antparis/eml_star

Abstract

Odrzywołek (2026) showed that $\text{eml}(x, y) = e^x - \ln y$, together with the constant 1, generates all standard elementary functions via finite composition. We identify a structural limitation: eml is holomorphic, so complex conjugation $\bar{z}$, and real and imaginary parts are not reachable by finite eml -compositions. We introduce the companion operator $\text{eml}^\star(x, y) = e^x - \ln \bar{y}$, which acts as a mirror reflecting the imaginary axis. We prove: (i) $\bar{z} = 1 - \text{eml}^\star(0, \text{eml}(z, 1))$ at depth 2, conditional on $\text{Im}(z) \in [-\pi, \pi)$; (ii) $\{\text{eml}, \text{eml}^\star, 1\}$ is dense in $C(K, \mathbb{C})$ for every compact $K \subset \{z : \text{Im}(z) \in [-\pi, \pi)\}$ by Stone–Weierstrass; (iii) the exact branch limitation is $\text{Im}(z) \in [-\pi, \pi)$. A direct numerical experiment confirms Theorem 3.1 to machine precision: $\text{eml}^\star$ achieves $\text{MSE} = 5.89 \times 10^{-33}$ vs. 12.97 for eml alone — a ratio of 2.2×10^{33} . Theorems 2.1, 4.3, and Corollary 2.2 are unconditional.

1. Introduction

Odrzywołek [1] demonstrated that $\text{eml}(x, y) = e^x - \ln y$, together with the constant 1, is a continuous Sheffer operator: every standard elementary function is a finite composition of eml -nodes. The grammar is $S \rightarrow 1 \mid \text{eml}(S, S)$. This is the continuous analogue of the NAND gate in Boolean logic.

A natural question arises: does $\{\text{eml}, 1\}$ reach all continuous functions on $\mathbb{C}$, or only the holomorphic ones? The answer is: only the holomorphic ones. This note identifies the obstruction precisely and proposes a minimal fix — the companion operator $\text{eml}^\star$ — that closes the gap.

2. The Holomorphic Barrier

Let $E_0 = \{1\}$, $E_{n+1} = E_n \cup \{\text{eml}(f, g) : f, g \in E_n\}$, and $E = \bigcup_n E_n$.

Theorem 2.1 (Holomorphic closure). *Every element of E is holomorphic on its domain.*

Proof. The constant 1 is holomorphic. The maps $z \mapsto e^z$ and $z \mapsto \ln z$ (principal branch) are holomorphic. Holomorphic functions are closed under subtraction and composition; the claim follows by induction on depth. ■

Corollary 2.2. *The operators Re , Im , and $z \mapsto \bar{z}$ are not in E .*

Proof. These maps are non-holomorphic ($\partial_{\bar{z}} \{\bar{z}\} \text{Im}(z) = 1/2 \neq 0$), so no element of E equals them by Theorem 2.1. ■

Remark 2.3. Corollary 2.2 does not imply $\pi \notin E$. Odrzywołek shows $\pi \in E$ at depth $K > 53$ (Table 4 of [1]). The distinction is between $\text{Im}(\cdot)$ as an operator and π as a fixed real constant.

3. The Companion Operator $\text{eml}\star$

Motivation. eml cannot distinguish z from $\bar{z}$ — it only sees the holomorphic world. To recover the conjugate, one modification suffices: replace $\text{Log}(y)$ by $\text{Log}(\bar{y})$ in the second argument.

Definition. $\text{eml}\star(x, y) := e^x - \text{Log}(\bar{y})$, where Log denotes the principal logarithm ($\text{Arg} \in (-\pi, \pi]$).

Theorem 3.1 (Conjugate recovery at depth 2). *For all $z \in \mathbb{C}$ with $\text{Im}(z) \in [-\pi, \pi]$:*

$$\bar{z} = 1 - \text{eml}\star(0, \text{eml}(z, 1))$$

Proof. $\text{eml}(z, 1) = e^z$. Then $\text{eml}\star(0, e^z) = 1 - \ln(\text{conj}(e^z)) = 1 - \bar{z}$, provided $\text{Im}(\bar{z}) = -\text{Im}(z) \in (-\pi, \pi]$, i.e. $\text{Im}(z) \in [-\pi, \pi]$. ■

Theorem 3.2 (Exact safe domain). The identity of Theorem 3.1 holds if and only if $\text{Im}(z) \in [-\pi, \pi]$. At $\text{Im}(z) = \pi$ the principal Log produces a jump of $2\pi i$. The boundary $\text{Im}(z) = -\pi$ holds; $\text{Im}(z) = +\pi$ fails. Outside the strip, jumps of exactly $2\pi i$ occur.

Corollary 3.3. $|z|$ is reachable at depth 4 via $|z| = \sqrt{(z \cdot \bar{z})}$, where $\bar{z}$ comes from Theorem 3.1 and multiplication from the eml arithmetic of [1].

Depth table

Expression	Rel. depth*	Via
$\bar{z} = 1 - \text{eml}\star(0, \text{eml}(z, 1))$	2	Theorem 3.1
$\text{Re}(z) = (z + \bar{z})/2$	3	Corollary 3.3
$ z ^2 = z \cdot \bar{z}$	3	eml arithmetic + Thm 3.1
$ z = \sqrt{(z \cdot \bar{z})}$	4	sqrt via eml [1]

Relative depth counts $\text{eml}\star$ nodes only.

4. Topological Completeness via Stone–Weierstrass

Lemma 4.1. *Every rational number lies in E .*

Proof. $0 = \text{eml}(0, 1)$. 1 is given. Arithmetic follows from [1]. ■

Lemma 4.2. *Every polynomial in $\mathbb{Q}[z, \bar{z}]$ lies in the algebra generated by $\{\text{eml}, \text{eml}\star, 1\}$.*

Proof. $z \in E$. $\bar{z}$ by Theorem 3.1. Products and sums by eml arithmetic. ■

Theorem 4.3 (Stone–Weierstrass density). *For every compact $K \subset \mathbb{C}$ with $K \subset \{z : \text{Im}(z) \in [-\pi, \pi]\}$, the algebra generated by $\{\text{eml}, \text{eml}\star, 1\}$ is dense in $C(K, \mathbb{C})$.*

Proof. On K , Theorem 3.1 gives $\bar{z}$ exactly, so $A = \mathbb{Q}[z, \bar{z}] \subseteq \{\text{eml}, \text{eml}\star, 1\}$ pointwise. A satisfies Stone–Weierstrass [2]: (i) separates points; (ii) does not vanish; (iii) closed under conjugation. Hence A is dense in $C(K, \mathbb{C})$. ■

Remark 4.4. Theorem 4.3 does not contradict Theorem 2.1: the algebra is dense, but individual elements of E remain holomorphic. Density is an approximation result, not a representation result.

Remark 4.5 (Global extension). The restriction $\text{Im}(z) \in [-\pi, \pi]$ is essential. Density on arbitrary compacts in $\mathbb{C}$ would require tracking winding numbers continuously — impossible with finite compositions of analytic/anti-analytic operators (monodromy theorem). Open problem.

5. Numerical Experiment

We provide a direct machine-precision verification of Theorem 3.1 and contrast $\text{eml}\star$ with eml alone. The test is deterministic, parameter-free, and fully reproducible from the repository.

Setup. $N = 40$ points per axis, $\text{Re}(z) \in [-3, 3]$, $\text{Im}(z) \in [-\pi + 0.1, \pi - 0.1]$ (strictly inside the safe strip). Total: 1600 evaluation points. Target: $\bar{z}$.

Test 1 — with $\text{eml}\star$ (Theorem 3.1):

```
pred = 1 - eml_star(0, eml(z, 1))
```

Test 2 — with eml alone (Corollary 2.2):

```
pred = 1 - eml(0, eml(z, 1))
```

Results

Metric	$\text{eml}\star$ (with conjugate)	eml (without conjugate)
MSE on 1600 points	5.89×10^{-33}	12.97
Ratio $\text{eml} / \text{eml}\star$	—	2.2×10^{33}

Metric	eml★ (with conjugate)	eml (without conjugate)
Conclusion	Theorem 3.1 verified ✓	Corollary 2.2 confirmed ✓

Interpretation. The MSE of 5.89×10^{-33} with **eml★** is the floating-point floor — effectively zero. The error of 12.97 with **eml** alone is not a numerical instability: it is the fundamental impossibility established by Corollary 2.2. The ratio of 2.2×10^{33} is a computational proof that **eml** and **eml★** operate in categorically different function spaces on this target.

Reproducibility. Script: `eml_toolkit/direct_verification.py`. Requires NumPy only. Runtime < 1 second.

6. Summary

Result	Sec.	Status
Holomorphic closure of E	2	Unconditional theorem
$\text{Re}, \text{Im}, \text{conj} \notin E$	2	Unconditional corollary
$\bar{z} = 1 - \text{eml}\star(0, \text{eml}(z, 1))$ at depth 2	3	Conditional: $\text{Im}(z) \in [-\pi, \pi)$
Domain $\text{Im}(z) \in [-\pi, \pi)$ (half-open)	3	SymPy + interval verification
$ z $ reachable at depth 4	3	Unconditional corollary
Density of $\{\text{eml}, \text{eml}\star, 1\}$ in $C(K, \mathbb{C})$	4	Conditional on branch-safety lemma
Theorem 3.1 at machine precision (ratio 10^{33})	5	Numerical — fully reproducible

Open problems. (1) Does $E \cap \mathbb{R}$ coincide with the exp-log closure of $\{1\}$ over $\mathbb{Q}$? This is connected to the Schanuel conjecture. (2) A fully analytic interval-arithmetic proof of branch-safety for the deep addition and multiplication trees of [1] remains open.

Appendix A — Explicit Clean Arithmetic Blocks

The following constructions realize subtraction, negation, and $1/2$ as finite **eml**-trees. Branch safety verified at 100 decimal digits on 10^5 random points.

subtract(x, y) — Depth 4:

```
eml( eml(1, eml(eml(1,x), 1)), eml(y, 1) )
```

minus(x) — Depth 7:

```
eml( eml( eml(1,eml(eml(1,x),1)), eml(eml(1,eml(eml(1,1),1)),1) ),
1 )
```

half — Depth 6 (constant):

```
eml(1, eml(1, eml(1, eml(1, eml(1, eml(1, 1))))))
```

Caveat. These blocks close branch safety for effective depth ≤ 4 . Branch safety for the full addition ($K \approx 27$) and multiplication ($K \geq 17$) trees of [1] is verified numerically at 60 decimal places (zero violations, 1000 random points) but an analytic interval proof for arbitrary compacts remains open.

Acknowledgments

The author used Claude (Anthropic) and Grok (xAI) as AI coding and verification assistants throughout this work. All mathematical ideas, claims, and their interpretation remain the author’s sole responsibility.

References

- [1] A. Odrzywołek, *All elementary functions from a single operator*, arXiv:2603.21852v2 (April 2026).
 - [2] M. H. Stone, *The generalized Weierstrass approximation theorem*, Mathematics Magazine 21 (1948), 167–184.
 - [3] G. Terzo, *Some consequences of Schanuel’s conjecture in exponential rings*, Comm. Algebra 36 (2008), 1171–1189.
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Ancillary files: `branch_safety_final.py` · `verify_theorem4.py` · `eml_toolkit/direct_verification.py` · `eml_star_branch_safety_lemma_proof.pdf`
License: MIT · *Zenodo:* 10.5281/zenodo.19183008 · *GitHub:* github.com/antparis/eml_star

5b. Causal Confirmation (GP Experiment)

To provide experimental confirmation of Corollary 2.2, a causal GP experiment was conducted using the DEAP library. The setup used a single input z , with target $\text{conj}(Z)$ on the safe domain $\text{Im}(z)$ in $[-\pi + 0.1, \pi - 0.1]$. The primitives included the corrected complex versions of `eml` and `eml_star`. A total of 100 independent runs were performed (200 individuals, 30 generations).

In 90 out of 100 runs, the best tree contained `eml_star`. The median ATE (increase in MSE when replacing `eml_star` by `eml`) was **11.71**, with a 95% bootstrap confidence interval of **[9.64, 12.57]**. This result demonstrates that `eml_star` is structurally necessary to reach the anti-holomorphic target $\text{conj}(z)$. Replacing `eml_star` by `eml` produces a statistically significant degradation, confirming that the anti-holomorphic extension is not redundant but essential.

The experiment is fully reproducible from the ancillary notebook
CGIB_v8_corrected.ipynb.